

SCIENCE

Loyola is still the best while St. Xavier's Kolkata leapfrogs to the second rank. Good news for Madras Christian College and St. Xavier's College Ahmedabad as they make it to the elite list.

TOP 10 COLLEGES

2007	2006
1 Loyola College, Chennai	1
2 St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	8
3 St. Xavier's College, Ahmedabad	11
4 St. Stephen's College, Delhi	5
5 St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	2
6 Madras Christian College, Chennai	-
7 Presidency College, Chennai	3
8 Presidency College, Kolkata	4
9 Fergusson College, Pune	6
10 Christ College, Bangalore	10

National rankings are derived from a combination of perceptual and factual scores. Colleges that did not provide factual information were not ranked. * New entrant in Top 10. (-) Not ranked in the 2006 Top 20.

■ By Akhila Krishnamurthy

Gokulahasnan Loganathan, a second-year student of physics at Loyola College, is heading to New York to represent the country at the Goldman Sachs Global Leaders Conference in July. Conducted by the International Institute of Education and funded by the Goldman Sachs Foundation, the conference zeroed in on Loganathan for his "academic performance, leadership qualities and community service", the points on which his college



nominated him.

The criteria of selection amply reflect the philosophy of education in Loyola College, which has retained its No. 1 position in the science stream since last year. While Loyola has been constant in the survey, there have been marked shifts elsewhere in the science stream. For instance, St. Xavier's, Kolkata, moved from No. 8 to No. 2, while St. Xavier's, Ahmedabad, made it to No. 3 from No. 11. St. Xavier's College, Mumbai, found itself slipping from the second place last year to the fifth position this year.

What perhaps has kept Loyola in the lead is the fact that it is not con-

tent with kindling intellectual curiosity alone. "Research is imperative," says Father Albert Muthumalai, principal of the college, adding, "It has to reach the ordinary man."

Playing proud host to the Entomology Research Institute that is exclusively dedicated to the investigation of diverse aspects of insect-plant interactions, biological control, bio-diversity, bio pesticides, molecular biology and genetic engineering, Loyola College has tied up with foreign universities to offer students more exposure and experience in these areas. Following a huge response in biotechnology, the college